

Alistair O'Brien

Osaka, Japan | Remote or Japan-based roles | Open to relocation | alistair.m.obrien@gmail.com | <https://jp.linkedin.com/in/alistair-o-brien>

SUMMARY

Senior C# Internal Tools & Automation Engineer with 10+ years of shipped product experience across full-stack production tooling, authoring workflows, build automation, localization pipelines, debugging systems, console porting, and performance optimization. I build practical software that reduces manual work for cross-functional teams, from user-facing tool interfaces to the data, workflow, and runtime systems behind them. Shipped work spans PC, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox, Android, and Web.

CORE SKILLS

- **Programming:** C#, Unity, Python automation/scripting, React, JavaScript
- **Internal tools:** Game engine editor tooling, full-stack tool interfaces, workflow automation, validation/debug tooling
- **Build and production:** Build automation, release workflows, CI/CD-adjacent tooling, platform configuration, deployment support, compliance and deployment on multiple consoles/platforms
- **Game and interactive systems:** Core game architecture, combat systems, animation tooling, UI frameworks, procedural generation
- **Platforms:** Windows, macOS, iOS, Android, Web, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox
- **Leadership:** Technical planning, workflow design, scheduling, budgeting, publisher communication

EXPERIENCE

Skeleton Crew Studio - Senior Programmer

Kyoto, Japan | October 2019 - Present

- Built production software, internal tools, and system architecture across games, VR, web, experimental experiences, and non-game projects.
- Designed tooling and workflow systems that reduced manual setup for designers, artists, programmers, and external collaborators.
- Automated build, deployment, localization, and debug workflows to shorten iteration cycles and make production state easier to inspect.
- Contributed to console porting work including graphics optimization, memory management, CPU performance, input, and platform-specific compliance.
- Led technical planning and production coordination through schedule design, budgeting, milestone planning, and clear communication loops.

Selected projects:

- Forestrike - Lead Programmer / Producer, Unity, C#, Python, Windows, Nintendo Switch
 - Led engineering and production planning for a shipped martial arts roguelite published by Devolver Digital.
 - Built a custom Aseprite importer, combat animation sequencer, player technique tooling, localization pipeline, and asset-driven audio layer for designer-authored content.
 - Set up remote build deployment workflows using Python and custom Unity tooling to speed up testing without disruptive branch management.
 - Optimized the Nintendo Switch version across graphics, memory, CPU, input, and independent server authentication.
- Olija - Programmer, Unity, C#, Windows, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, Xbox
 - Supported multi-platform porting across PC, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation, and Xbox.
 - Documented and automated platform build processes including asset conversion, scripting defines, input configuration, and build target setup.
 - Built debug overlays and investigated platform-specific runtime bugs in production builds.

Active Gaming Media - Programmer

Osaka, Japan | March 2018 - October 2019

- Built Unity/C# game architecture and gameplay systems for an internal game project.
- Led a team of roughly eight developers with emphasis on technical planning, workflow improvements, and delivery.
- Developed tools and Unity systems to support production needs and reduce repeated manual work.

Scarlet City Studios - Programmer / Technical Artist

Auckland, New Zealand | December 2013 - July 2017

- Moved from art production into technical art, shader work, tools, and frontend gameplay programming.
- Built mobile-friendly shaders, combat frontend work, quest content, and designer-facing animation timeline tools.
- Contributed to The Aetherlight across Unity, C#, Java, Blender, Photoshop, Windows, macOS, iOS, Android, and Web.

EDUCATION

Auckland University of Technology

Auckland, New Zealand | Bachelor of Art and Design, Digital Design | 2011 - 2013

- Graduated as Head of School.